and humiliation. An Englishman occupying a high position said, that he would have preferred it if the *Prince of Wales* and the *Repulse* had been sunk by the Germans instead of by the yellow Japanese.

The visit of the Chinese leaders, Generalissimo and Madame Chiang Kai-shek, was a great event in India. Official conventions and the wishes of the Government of India prevented them from

**Liddell Hart: 'The Strategy of Indirect Approach' (1941), Preface.*

mixing with the people, but their presence in India itself **at that** critical stage and their manifest sympathy for India's **freedom** helped to bring India out of her national shell and increased her awareness of the international issues at stake. The bonds that tied India and China grew stronger, and so did the desire to line up with China and other nations against the common adversary. The peril to India helped to bring nationalism and internationalism close together, the only separating factor being the policy of the British Government.

The Government of India were no doubt very conscious of the approaching perils; there must have been anxiety in their minds and a sense of urgency. But such was the conventional existence of